

This short text belongs to the extensive genre of dhāraṇī and mantra literature

Toh 791 · Derge Kangyur

This short text belongs to the extensive genre of dhāraṇī and mantra literature preserved in the Kangyur, and appears here as Toh 791, concluding one protective spell before introducing another. The passage first closes a "dhāraṇī for protecting oneself" (Bdag bsrung ba'i gzungs), a formula to be recited over water and scattered in the ten directions for personal protection, then opens a new noble dhāraṇī called "Pleasing to the Mind," invoking the Buddha and his uṣṇīṣa through a Sanskrit mantra. This latter spell is presented as a practical charm — to be recited over substances such as bezoar, collyrium, or water, and then applied to the forehead, eyes, or ingested — in order to make the practitioner pleasing and attractive to others and to inspire generosity in those they encounter. As a work of applied ritual magic rather than doctrinal exposition, it exemplifies the tradition of dhāraṇī texts embedded in the Kangyur that combine invocation, mantra, and simple physical rites for worldly benefit and protection.

Svāhā. Facing the sun, having cast this mantra upon water seven times, if one scatters it in the ten directions, one will be protected. The dhāraṇī for protecting oneself is complete.

The noble [dhāraṇī] called Pleasing to the Mind.

Homage to the Buddha, the Blessed One.

Namo bhagavate uṣṇīṣāya, dhāre dharaṇātiye svāhā.

Even without formal accomplishment, it succeeds merely through recitation. If it is recited one hundred and eight times over bezoar (gi wang) and a dot is placed with it upon the forehead, one becomes pleasing to the minds of all. If the mantra is recited over collyrium and applied to the eyes, then whomever one looks upon, the meeting of gazes will be harmonious. If it is recited over water and that water is drunk, others will feel a heartfelt wish to give one food.

The dhāraṇī Pleasing to the Mind is complete.

Translator's Notes

- "Gi wang" (Tib. gi wang) refers to bezoar, a substance used in Tibetan ritual and medicine, corresponding to Skt. gorocanā; it is kept here in its Tibetan form as no single standard English equivalent is established. The exact Sanskrit title underlying "Pleasing to the Mind" (yid du 'ong

ba) is uncertain and has been left untranslated in Sanskrit to avoid speculative reconstruction.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.